

System Administration & Maintenance

System Administration Ethics

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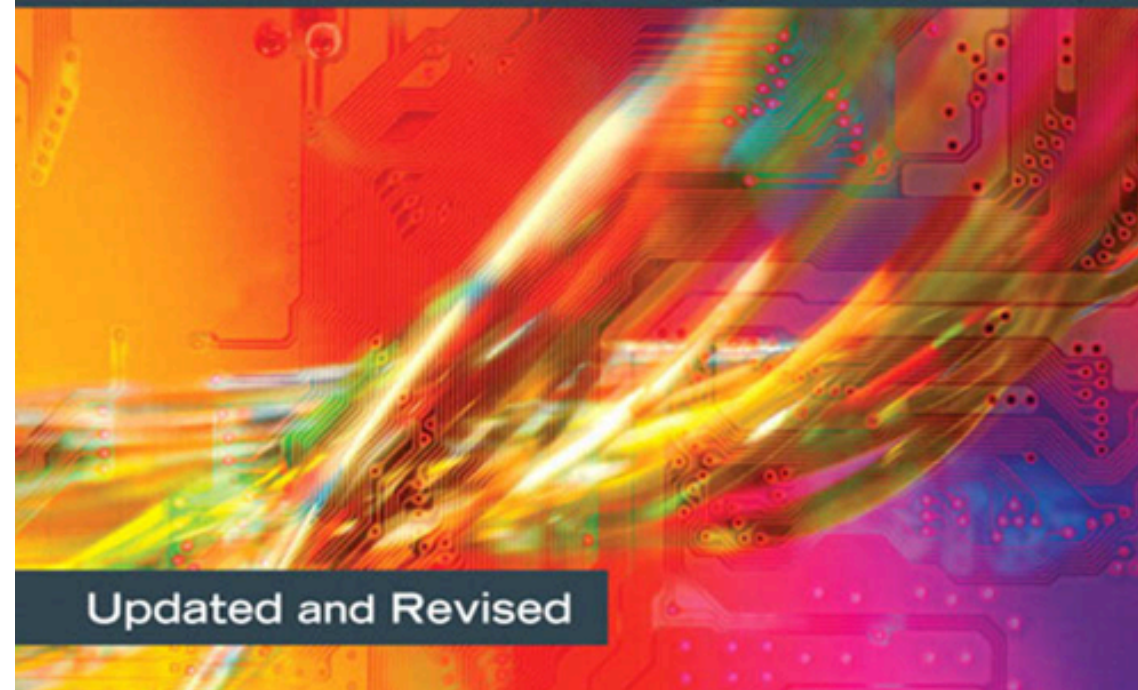
References You Can Look At!

1.

The
Practice of
System and Network
Administration

Second Edition

Thomas A. Limoncelli • Christina J. Hogan • Strata R. Chalup



Ethics in System Administration

Ethics in system administration governs how professionals manage the immense trust, access, and power they hold over organizational networks

- Use authority responsibly
- Protect users and systems
- behave professionally

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Why Ethics are Important?

System administrators often have:

- Access to confidential data
- Administrator privileges
- Control over user accounts, systems, and networks

.
Because of this:

- Misuse can cause serious damage
- Trust is extremely important.

Ethical Responsibilities of SA

System administrators should:

- Respect privacy
- Protect user data
- Maintain system security
- Follow organizational policies
- Avoid misuse of privileges

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Informed Consent

Users should be informed before actions affecting them are performed.

Ex.

- Rebooting servers
- Changing passwords
- Monitoring activity

Otherwise, users lose their trust, systems may be disrupted, and organizations may face complaints

The SA's Code of Ethics

- **Professionalism**

- I will maintain professional conduct in the workplace and will not allow personal feelings or beliefs to cause me to treat people unfairly or unprofessionally.

- **Laws and Policies**

- I will educate myself and others on relevant laws, regulations, and policies regarding the performance of my duties.

The SA's Code of Ethics

- **Personal Integrity.**

- I will be honest in my professional dealings and forthcoming about my competence and the impact of my mistakes. I will seek assistance from others when required.
- I will avoid conflicts of interest and biases whenever possible. When my advice is sought, if I have a conflict of interest or bias, I will declare it if appropriate, and recuse myself if necessary.

The SA's Code of Ethics

- **System Integrity**.

- I will strive to ensure the necessary integrity, reliability, and availability of the systems for which I am responsible.
- I will design and maintain each system in a manner to support the purpose of the system to the organization.

The SA's Code of Ethics

- **Privacy.**

- I will access private information on computer systems only when it is necessary in the course of my technical duties.
- I will maintain and protect the confidentiality of any information to which I may have access, regardless of the method by which I came into knowledge of it.

The SA's Code of Ethics

- **Ethical Responsibility**

- I will strive to build and maintain a safe, healthy, and productive workplace.
- I will do my best to make decisions consistent with the safety, privacy, and well-being of my community and the public, and to disclose promptly factors that might pose unexamined risks or dangers.

Social Engineering

Manipulating people to gain unauthorized access or information.

Attackers may:

- Pretend to be employees.
- Pretend to be law enforcement

Preventing Social Engineering

SA should follow good practices to prevent a social engineering attack.

- Always verify Identity.
- Follow procedures
 - Contact higher management or the legal department.
- Never share sensitive information over the telephone
- Report suspicious activities

Working with Law Enforcement

Organizations should have a policy on working with law enforcement agencies so that they know what to do if one contacts them.

- Relax. Becalmed.
- Follow organizational policy.
- Verify identity.
- Request proper authorization
- Document actions taken

Ethical Dilemmas

A difficult situation where deciding the correct action is challenging like manager asks to access employee emails.

Ask these questions yourself:

- Is it ethical?
- What policy applies?

Ethical Dilemmas

What to Do?

When you're unsure what to do:

- Ask again to verify the request (you might have misunderstood)
- Follow organizational policy.
- Contact higher management
- Document/keep logs of the actions
- Request written authorization
- Document actions taken

Consequences of Unethical Behavior

Possible consequences:

- Loss of trust
- Legal issues
- Data breaches
- Job termination
- Reputation damage

Thank You